Ibn Zohr University
Faculty of Science,
English Language and Culture

Unit I: Social Media
Level: S6
Teaching Objectives :
By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- *Understand and use vocabulary related to social media regulation.*
- *Use plural forms accurately (regular and irregular) in context.*
- *Express and justify their opinions using appropriate connectors.*
- *Write a coherent argumentative paragraph (150–170 words)*

I. A Lead in activity

A) Match Words with Definitions

Word	Definition
regulation	rules made by governments
Enforce	make sure people follow a law or rule
platform	a social media service (Instagram, TikTok, etc.)
engagement	how much people interact online
misinformation	false or misleading information online

3. READING TEXT

Social Media Regulation in a Digital Age

Recent debates over social media regulation have gained global momentum. In 2025, Australia became the first country to adopt a *Social Media Minimum Age* law, requiring major platforms to take steps to prevent users under 16 years of age from creating or keeping accounts. The aim of the law is to protect teenagers' *mental health, privacy, and safety online* by limiting early exposure to addictive feeds, harmful content, and algorithm-driven engagement. Companies that fail to comply may face substantial fines.

Supporters of the law argue that social platforms were originally designed to maximise users' time and attention, often without adequate safeguards for minors. They claim that younger teens are especially vulnerable to cyberbullying, pressure from online images, and misinformation. Critics, however, caution that outright age limits could push young people toward *less-regulated platforms*, use of VPNs to bypass restrictions, or reduce important social connections. They also argue that digital literacy — teaching young people how to evaluate content responsibly — might be a more effective long-term solution.

As nations around the world observe Australia's experiment, policymakers in countries such as Denmark, Germany, and France are considering their own age-based restrictions or parental consent requirements. These discussions raise complex questions about personal freedom, children's rights, cultural norms, and the responsibilities of technology companies in a digital society.

READING COMPREHENSION

I. Vocabulary in Context

A. Match the word to the closest meaning.

1. regulation	a. protection against harm
2. enforcement	b. avoid or go around a rule
3. vulnerable	c. follow a rule or law
4. bypass	d. official control by authority
5. comply	e. interaction and participation
6. engagement	f. at risk or easily harmed
7. safeguard	g. limitation
8. restriction	h. making sure rules are followed
9. gain global momentum	h. expand worldwide

B. Collocation Work

Match the beginnings and endings:

1. impose	a. concerns
2. protect	b. young users
3. face	c. restrictions
4. raise	d. digital literacy
5. promote	e. online content
6. access	f. financial penalties

C. Choose the best word:

1. Teenagers are particularly (sensitive / enforced) to online comparison.
2. Platforms may face serious (penalties / engagement).
3. The law might be difficult to (comply / enforce).
4. Some users try to (bypass / restrict) age verification systems.

II. Answer the following questions :

A) True / False / Correct

1. Australia's law completely blocks children under 16 from using the internet.
2. Critics say age limits might lead teens to other unregulated platforms.
3. Educators believe digital literacy alone can help young people online.

B) Answer these questions:

1. Why did Australia introduce this law?
2. List two arguments supporters use to justify it.
3. What concern do critics have about enforcement?

III. Speaking Activity: Opinion (Class Discussion)

Do you think age restrictions on social media help or harm society?

Choose some of the following phrases to frame your answer:

Part B — Opinion Language Bank

1. Stating Your Position

- In my view, this measure is justified because…
- I am convinced that regulating access is necessary.
- I tend to believe that education is more effective than prohibition.
- Personally, I find this regulation problematic.

2. Giving Reasons

- One major concern is that…

- The primary issue lies in…
- The fundamental problem with unrestricted access is…
- A key argument in favour of the law is that…

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3. Adding Examples

- For instance…
- A clear example of this can be seen in…
- This is particularly evident when…

5. GRAMMAR FOCUS – PLURAL

2. Rule Clarification (But Concise)

A. Regular Plurals

- platform → platforms
- law → laws
- user → users

B. -y Endings

- policy → policies
- company → companies
- responsibility → responsibilities

C. -es Endings

- class → classes
- process → processes
- address → addresses

D. Irregular Plurals (Important at B2)

- child → children
- person → people
- man → men
- woman → women
- phenomenon → phenomena
- criterion → criteria

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3. Controlled Practice (Contextualised)

Exercise A – Choose the Correct Form

1. Governments impose strict (policy / policies).
2. Many (child / children) are exposed to harmful content.
3. Social media companies develop complex (algorithm / algorithms).
4. Teenagers face different (challenge / challenges).
5. Several (country / countries) are considering similar laws.

Exercise B – Error Correction

Correct the mistakes:

1. These regulation affect many familys.
2. Many young person use multiple account.
3. Social medias influence modern society.

4. Countable vs Uncountable (Very Relevant Here)

Explain briefly:

- Information (NOT informations)
- Content (uncountable in general sense)
- Advice (NOT advices)
- Evidence (NOT evidences)

Practice:

Correct:

1. The platform spreads many informations.
2. Parents need more advices.
3. There are many contents online.
4.

7. WRITING TASK (20 minutes)

✍□ WRITING TASK

◆ Task Prompt

Topic:

Should governments regulate social media access for teenagers?

Write a **150–170 word paragraph** expressing your opinion.

Pre-Writing Planning (5 minutes)

Students fill this quick plan before writing:

My position: _____

Argument 1: _____

Argument 2: _____

rrConclusion idea: _____

Clear Structural Model

A good paragraph should include:

1. **Topic sentence** (clear position)
2. **First argument + explanation**
3. **Second argument + explanation**
4. **Concluding sentence**

Sample Sentence Starters :

◆ Topic Sentence Options

- Governments should regulate social media access because…
- In my opinion, regulating social media is necessary in modern societies.
- The question of social media regulation has become increasingly controversial.

◆ Introducing Arguments

- One important reason is that…
- A major concern is that…
- Another significant issue involves…
- Research suggests that…

◆ Adding Explanation

- This means that…
- As a result…
- Consequently…
- This often leads to…

◆ Concluding Sentence

- For these reasons, regulation appears to be justified.
- Therefore, governments must act responsibly in protecting young users.
- Ultimately, a balanced approach may be the most effective solution.